

festival

New Versus Old

CHENNAI One may call it a culmination of artistic perspectives. City-based Prakriti Foundation is all set to present The Park's New Festival between December 2 and 6 at the Museum Theatre. In its new avatar, the New Festival, that replaces the very sought-after Other Festival, is a cultural pit stop that will showcase new and emerging work in performing arts—dance, music and theatre.

This being its inaugural year, the festival also attempts to celebrate the comfortable co-existence of "tradition and modernity, classicism and experimentation" in art and culture in today's India. The event premieres at the Museum Theatre with *Two Lives in Dance... And Two More*, a dance and spoken word presentation by Mrinalini Sarabhai and Mallika Sarabhai that will be followed on December 3 with *Jazz*, a play by Stagesmith, a Mumbai-based theatre company. Catering to contemporary sensibilities is a performance titled *Porcelain* by

city-based dancer Preethi Athreya. This dance solo that features the work of Walter and Tobias Sturmer and being presented in association with the Alliance Francaise, Chennai, explores the sound and image of this dexterous material—porcelain—and is an expression of the dancer's response to the same. "In a sense, it's a creation that bears witness to the absurd frailty of all human endeavour," says Athreya. On December 5, Vayu Naidu Company, UK, is presenting *Mistaken... Annie Besant in India*, a play written by Rukhsana Ahmad and directed by Chris Banfield.

The grand finale is *Dhara*, a dance presentation by Dance Routes, Bhubaneswar that poignantly showcases the Raghurajpur Lila project. *Dhara* has been directed by Rekha Tandon and with music by Michael Weston, it is a must-watch.

Season donor passes priced at Rs 500 and Rs 1,000 are available at Landmark, Shilpi, Prana, Chamiers and Amethyst.

by **Akhila Krishnamurthy**

A scene from the play *Mistaken...Annie Besant in India*



music

Classic Ensemble

DELHI The organisers of music festivals often face a challenge while promoting classical music. Most believe fusion music concerts are a smart way of arousing interest in the youth and attracting them to classical concerts. But santoor maestro Pandit Bhajan Sopori thinks the best way to arouse interest is to promote young classical musicians. This year at the two-day SaMaPa festival starting December 1, the young Kedia brothers will be showcasing their talent on the sitar and the sarod. There will be a santoor ensemble by his disciples and a solo performance by his son Abhay Rustum Sopori. Pandit Sopori, who hails from Kashmir, says, "with its motto *Jan Jan Tak Sangeet* (music to the masses), SaMaPa serves as a cultural bridge between Jammu and Kashmir and the rest of the country by representing the heartbeat of the state's people and its culture." The festival also features Madhup Mudgal (vocal), Pandit Kishan Maharaj (tabla), Pandit Samresh Chawdhury (vocal), Harish Tivari (vocal) and Kiran Sehgal (Odissi). At Kamani Auditorium.

by **S. Sahaya Ranjit**

Madhup Mudgal (left) and Abhay Rustum Sopori



sculptures

Code Bronze

DELHI Gallery Threshold presents Limited Editions, an exhibition of bronze sculptures from November 25 to December 4. The exhibition highlights a continued exploration of the elements of medium and scale, the elements of form, colour and texture, and of various themes by some of the most significant Indian



A work by Swaroopini sculptors like Dhruva Mistry, Shanti Swaroopini, Mrinalini Mukherjee and Sukhdev Rathod. At Gallerie Romain Rolland, Alliance Francaise.